Houston Aquarium

Operations Omnibus

The complete operational package, April 2026

Facility	5440 N Sam Houston Parkway East, Houston, TX
Owner	Family Fun Group
Version	April 21, 2026

This document is the record copy of the Houston operations package. Each section in this binder also exists as a stand-alone PDF for posting on walls, handing to staff, and daily field use. This binder is for the owner, the GM, and training new leadership.

Core LIFE rule: If it is not assigned, written, or approved — do not do it.

Contents

Page numbers refer to this omnibus. Each section is also a stand-alone PDF in the same folder.

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Editing note. Individual PDFs for field use are in the same folder as this omnibus. Edit only the individual PDFs. Rebuild this omnibus after edits.

Employee Evaluation Sheet

Follow-through, accuracy, and fit

Employee name		**Role**	
Facility (HA / AA / SA)		**Reviewer**	
Hire date		**Review date**	
Review period			

The three questions this evaluation answers

1. Did they finish what they started?
2. Was it done correctly?
3. Did someone have to redo it?

Scoring key

4	Consistently — no redo needed
3	Usually — minor correction
2	Inconsistent — frequent redo
1	Not meeting standard
N/A	Not in scope for this role

Core rule: If it is not assigned, written, or approved — do not do it.

Follow-through scoring

Score each behavior based on what can be observed. Use the scoring key on page 1. Leave a note for every score of 2 or below.

Behavior	Observed examples	Score	Notes
1. Completes assigned tasks in the time given	Tasks finish before end of shift without reminders.		
2. Finishes what they start without being asked twice	One prompt is enough. No task is left half-done.		
3. Follows written checklists exactly	No substitutions, no self-initiated improvements.		
4. Reports unfinished tasks before end of shift	Written report in log or group, not verbal only.		
5. Work does not have to be redone by another staff member	No second-pass cleanup, no corrections after clock-out.		
6. Follows the diet sheet exactly	No grams, whole items only, no substitutions.		
7. Uses the escalation ladder instead of solo-deciding	Asks lead or manager before changing any step.		
8. Does not rewrite structure, signs, or SOPs	No new signs, no edits to posted instructions.		
9. Stays in their claim-based work lane	No freelancing into another person's claim.		
10. Completes opening or closing checklist in full and signs off	Every line initialed. No blanks. No back-fill.		

Accuracy and safety scoring

Score each item based on direct observation or verified records. Safety items are pass or fail — a score of 1 or 2 on any safety row triggers a written review.

Behavior	Observed examples	Score	Notes
1. Animal diet accuracy	Correct items, correct enclosure, correct time.		
2. Cash, POS, and redemption accuracy	Drawer balances. Redemptions match records.		
3. Cleaning protocol accuracy	Right product, right order, right surface.		
4. Guest interaction accuracy	Follows script. Does not ad-lib policy.		
5. Zero-waste protocol adherence	Sort, log, dispose per written protocol.		
6. Diet verification sign-offs complete	Verification only — no assessment, no edits.		
7. No live prey, no unauthorized substitutions	Never. No exceptions. No field decisions.		
8. Tortoises: hay only	No greens, no fruit, no vegetables — ever.		
9. Zero staff feeding of stingrays, fish, sharks	Only scheduled feeders during scheduled times.		
10. Reports hazards, not hides them	Writes it up. Tags it. Tells a manager.		

Fit and continuation

Short-answer observations. Write what was seen, not what was felt.

What tasks does this employee do without needing a reminder?

What tasks consistently require follow-up from a manager?

Has their work had to be redone by another employee in the last 30 days? If yes, how many times and on what?

Has this employee modified or rewritten any sign, SOP, or diet without approval?

Observed strengths (mechanism-focused, not personality):

Gaps that would prevent promotion:

Recommendation (check one)

- ☐ Continue — meeting standard
- ☐ Continue with coaching plan — attach written plan below
- ☐ Final written warning — specific behaviors must improve within 30 days
- ☐ Termination recommended — write reason

Coaching plan (if checked): specific behaviors and deadline

Signatures

Employee		**Date**	
Reviewer		**Date**	
GM		**Date**	

Signing acknowledges review. Signing does not indicate agreement. Written disagreement may be attached.

The 30+ hire filter

Use during onboarding or as a re-evaluation lens.

Follow-through indicators to watch for in the first 30 days

Confirm each behavior by direct observation. Check the box when confirmed.

- ☐ 1. Arrives on time, every shift
- ☐ 2. Reads the written task before starting
- ☐ 3. Asks one clarifying question, then proceeds — does not spiral
- ☐ 4. Uses checklists without prompting
- ☐ 5. Reports progress mid-shift, not only at the end
- ☐ 6. Finishes one task before starting the next
- ☐ 7. Flags problems in writing (WhatsApp group or log) — not verbally only
- ☐ 8. Returns tools and supplies to the marked location
- ☐ 9. Does not bring personal opinions into guest interactions
- ☐ 10. Does not modify animal diets under any circumstance
- ☐ 11. Signs off on diet verification every time
- ☐ 12. When uncertain, uses the escalation ladder

Observer notes

This sheet evaluates what can be observed. It does not evaluate what cannot be proven. Structure overrides transmission.

Houston Aquarium

Opening Duties

Family Fun Group · 5440 N Sam Houston Pkwy E · Owner: Ammon Covino

DATE _____ SHIFT LEAD _____

WEATHER _____ NOTES _____

This packet covers every space at Houston Aquarium. Each section is one page and is posted on the relevant wall. Read the rules below before you begin. The park closes to daytime guests at 7:00 PM. After that, the venue, arcade, restaurant, outside bar, and pickleball courts run as the night economy and must be ready.

FIVE HARD RULES — OPENING	
1	If it is not assigned, written, or approved — do not do it.
2	Checklists are completed in order. No skipping.
3	Sign and time each section when done.
4	If something is broken or missing, note it on the sheet AND post it in HA Maintenance WhatsApp group before end of shift.
5	Do not modify any diet, sign, or SOP. Structure overrides transmission.

Reminder: Structure overrides transmission. If it is not written, it is not approved. Post broken items to HA Maintenance WhatsApp group before end of shift.

1. Aquarium Exhibit Floor

OPENING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Husbandry Lead + Floor Supervisor	Complete 30 minutes before gates open.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Walk the full exhibit loop. Lights on, all tanks visible, no leaks, no fallen signs.	
2	[ ]	Check every animal visually — present and alive. Note anything unusual on this sheet and in HA Husbandry WhatsApp.	
3	[ ]	Confirm diets staged for the day per the posted diet sheet. No substitutions.	
4	[ ]	Tortoise enclosure: hay only. No greens. Confirm fresh water.	
5	[ ]	Lemur enclosure: whole-fruit items staged per steward note — no grams, no substitutions.	
6	[ ]	Bird leftovers collected from kitchen for birds — zero food waste protocol.	
7	[ ]	Water quality spot-check: temperature and clarity on each display tank, log on posted sheet.	
8	[ ]	Trash emptied. Walkways swept. No debris in guest path.	
9	[ ]	Gift shop register opened, float counted and signed, POS online.	
10	[ ]	Gift shop animal section tidy — Smithsonian-educational materials facing out, no carnival items.	
11	[ ]	Do-Not-List posted at the front desk and visible. QR codes scannable with a test phone.	
12	[ ]	Staff radios on, channel 1. Confirm range walk from back-of-house to gift shop.	
13	[ ]	Report unusual animal behavior in HA Husbandry group before doors open.	
14	[ ]	Final loop 10 minutes before gates open — confirm no standing water, no unlocked back doors, no missing signage.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

2. Studio Giraffe Venue

OPENING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Event Host + Venue Attendant	Complete 60 minutes before event start (event days only).

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Confirm event booking posted on the door. Setup sheet printed and at the host stand.	
2	[ ]	Tables, chairs, and linens staged per the setup sheet — count matches the booking, no guesses.	
3	[ ]	AV check: sound system, house lighting scenes, wireless microphones — test each mic.	
4	[ ]	Projector and screen test if booking requires it. Spare HDMI cable on the cart.	
5	[ ]	Restrooms stocked: paper, soap, towels, sanitary bin liners.	
6	[ ]	Confirm event host is assigned and has the setup sheet. No freelance menu changes.	
7	[ ]	If sleep-with-sharks booking: bedding staged, nightlight placed, safety signage confirmed on the wall.	
8	[ ]	Welcome signage placed at the entry with the booking name — spelled as on the sheet.	
9	[ ]	Kitchen tie-in confirmed with Longneck — timing card printed and on the pass.	
10	[ ]	Trash cans lined, recycling bin present.	
11	[ ]	HVAC set to event temperature per posted spec.	
12	[ ]	Radios on channel 1, host carries one at all times.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

3. Longneck Kitchen

OPENING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Kitchen Manager + Front-of-House Lead	Complete 30 minutes before doors.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Lights up, music at service volume, HVAC set to service setting.	
2	[ ]	Host station: paper menus stocked, waiting-menu tablet loaded, concierge seating chart printed for today.	
3	[ ]	Front-of-house walkthrough: tables set, silverware polished, water pitchers stocked at every station.	
4	[ ]	Kitchen line check: ticket printer paper loaded, POS online, prep sheet posted on the line.	
5	[ ]	Cooler and walk-in temps logged on the posted sheet. Report any reading outside spec.	
6	[ ]	Daily specials written on the board — approved specials only, no freelance items.	
7	[ ]	Bar stocked: beer, wine, spirits per par sheet. Glassware polished.	
8	[ ]	Restrooms checked twice before doors — paper, soap, towels, mirrors.	
9	[ ]	Allergen and 86'd item list posted at the line and at the host stand.	
10	[ ]	Reservations reviewed at the host stand — VIPs flagged per posted list.	
11	[ ]	Host and server stations radios on, channel 2. Earpieces charged.	
12	[ ]	30-minute pre-service staff meeting: 15 minutes max, covers VIPs, 86'd items, specials.	
13	[ ]	Final walkthrough 10 minutes before doors — confirm music, lighting, HVAC, and greeter in place.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

4. The Arcade + Redemption Area

OPENING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Arcade Lead + Redemption Attendant	Complete 20 minutes before doors.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	All machines powered on — test-play each row for responsiveness before doors.	
2	[ ]	Ticket printers loaded with paper. Test-print one ticket per bank.	
3	[ ]	Token dispensers loaded and counted. Float signed on the posted sheet.	
4	[ ]	Redemption counter: prizes visible, PRICES posted on every item — no unpriced items on the shelf.	
5	[ ]	Confirm Smithsonian-grade inventory present: telescopes, binoculars, microscope kits, rock sets, pocket knives.	
6	[ ]	No low-end carnival inventory on the shelves. Anything unapproved goes to the back and is logged.	
7	[ ]	Sweep the floor. Wipe every screen. Wipe joysticks and buttons with approved cleaner.	
8	[ ]	Change machines checked — bills and coins loaded, counted, signed.	
9	[ ]	Card reader and POS at the redemption counter online. Test one transaction.	
10	[ ]	Report any broken machine on this sheet AND in HA Maintenance WhatsApp.	
11	[ ]	Posted Do-Not-Award list reviewed — high-value items require staff hand-off, no self-grab.	
12	[ ]	Staff radios on, channel 3. Earpieces in.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

5. Pickleball Courts (Outdoor)

OPENING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Courts Attendant	Complete 30 minutes before first reserved play.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Walkthrough of every court: nets tight, lines visible, no debris, no standing water.	
2	[ ]	Check-in station powered on. Scoreboard tested on each court.	
3	[ ]	Equipment rental bin stocked: paddles counted, balls counted, grip tape available.	
4	[ ]	Shade and umbrellas deployed per today's weather call — anchored, not just set up.	
5	[ ]	Water station filled. Cups stocked. Ice if temperature is over 85 degrees.	
6	[ ]	Cross-promotion TV powered on. Rotating playlist running — venue, arcade, restaurant, sleep-with-sharks.	
7	[ ]	Sign-up sheet visible at the check-in station. Pen attached with cord, not loose.	
8	[ ]	First-aid kit present and sealed. Log any missing items.	
9	[ ]	Sunscreen station stocked if posted.	
10	[ ]	Court lights tested on a timed switch if evening play is on the schedule.	
11	[ ]	Radios on channel 4. Check-in staff carries one.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

6. Outside Bar

OPENING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Bar Lead	Complete 20 minutes before bar opens (night-economy shift).

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Ice bins filled to the marked line. Backup ice staged.	
2	[ ]	Beer reach-ins stocked per par sheet. Rotate oldest to the front.	
3	[ ]	Garnishes cut: lemons, limes, mint. Dated and covered.	
4	[ ]	POS and card reader online. Test one sale.	
5	[ ]	Glassware polished and stocked at every station.	
6	[ ]	Menu boards updated with today's pours and prices. No freelance additions.	
7	[ ]	Wristband check station set for age-restricted area. Wristbands, pens, and sign posted.	
8	[ ]	Cross-promotion TV on with venue, kitchen, arcade playlist.	
9	[ ]	Trash cans lined, recycling bin present and labeled.	
10	[ ]	Handwash sink has soap, paper towels, sanitizer bucket made fresh.	
11	[ ]	Floor mats down and dry behind the bar.	
12	[ ]	Radios on channel 2. Bar lead carries one.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

7. Sleep-with-Sharks Rooms

OPENING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Event Host + Housekeeping	Complete 90 minutes before guest check-in (booking days only).

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Confirm booking name on the door placard. Spelled as on the booking sheet.	
2	[ ]	Bedding fresh, tight corners, pillows full. Extra blanket at the foot of the bed.	
3	[ ]	Nightstand items present per spec: water bottles, flashlight, welcome card.	
4	[ ]	Narration Suite wall content intact — every panel present. No staff-written additions.	
5	[ ]	Safety signage present: no flash photography, quiet hours, emergency exits.	
6	[ ]	Temperature set per the posted spec for sleep-with-sharks rooms.	
7	[ ]	Welcome packet placed on the bed — booking name matches placard.	
8	[ ]	Narration suite QR link tested with a staff phone. Opens to the correct page.	
9	[ ]	Tank viewing glass wiped inside the room. No streaks.	
10	[ ]	Lights dimmed to the posted overnight level. Nightlight on.	
11	[ ]	Bathroom stocked: paper, soap, towels, hairdryer tested.	
12	[ ]	Final walkthrough by event host before guest check-in.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

Shift Sign-Off Sheet

OPENING — one line per space. Shift lead signs after each space lead confirms completion.

Space	Lead Initial	Time	Complete? Y/N	Exceptions?
1. Aquarium Exhibit Floor				
2. Studio Giraffe Venue				
3. Longneck Kitchen				
4. The Arcade + Redemption Area				
5. Pickleball Courts (Outdoor)				
6. Outside Bar				
7. Sleep-with-Sharks Rooms				

EXCEPTIONS NOTED BELOW — record anything unfinished, broken, or unusual. Post to HA Maintenance or HA Leadership WhatsApp as required.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

SHIFT LEAD (PRINT) _____ SIGNATURE _____ TIME _____

Houston Aquarium

Closing Duties

Family Fun Group · 5440 N Sam Houston Pkwy E · Owner: Ammon Covino

DATE _____ SHIFT LEAD _____

WEATHER _____ NOTES _____

This packet covers every space at Houston Aquarium. Each section is one page and is posted on the relevant wall. Read the rules below before you begin. The park closes to daytime guests at 7:00 PM. After that, the venue, arcade, restaurant, outside bar, and pickleball courts run as the night economy and must be ready.

FIVE HARD RULES — CLOSING	
1	Leave every space better than you found it. No exceptions.
2	Lock and log — every door, every cage, every cash drawer, every keyboard.
3	Anything unfinished goes in writing to morning shift via HA Leadership WhatsApp before you leave.
4	Broken or missing items are posted to HA Maintenance WhatsApp the same night, not tomorrow.
5	Do not modify any diet, sign, or SOP. Structure overrides transmission.

Reminder: Structure overrides transmission. If it is not written, it is not approved. Post broken items to HA Maintenance WhatsApp group before end of shift.

1. Aquarium Exhibit Floor

CLOSING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Husbandry Lead + Floor Supervisor	Complete within 45 minutes after 7:00 PM close.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Final animal walk — every animal present, no distress signs, log anything unusual.	
2	[ ]	Tanks topped off per the posted schedule. No diet modifications, no feeding off-cycle.	
3	[ ]	Tortoise hay restocked for overnight. Water refreshed.	
4	[ ]	Lemur enclosure observation logged — activity level, food consumed, anything unusual.	
5	[ ]	Water quality evening readings logged on the posted sheet.	
6	[ ]	Gift shop register closed, cash dropped, counted by two staff, signed by both.	
7	[ ]	Gift shop reset for tomorrow — shelves faced, educational materials restocked.	
8	[ ]	Trash to dumpster. Floors swept and mopped. Walkway mats shaken out.	
9	[ ]	All public-facing lights lowered to overnight level per posted setting.	
10	[ ]	Animal-care doors and back-of-house gates locked. Keys returned to the key board and signed.	
11	[ ]	Do-Not-List reviewed — any new additions from the day posted before morning.	
12	[ ]	Radios off the charging dock, batteries plugged in for morning shift.	
13	[ ]	Anything unfinished written on this sheet AND posted to morning shift via HA Leadership WhatsApp.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

2. Studio Giraffe Venue

CLOSING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Event Host + Venue Attendant	Complete within 90 minutes after event end.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Event breakdown per the posted sheet. Every item returned to its marked location.	
2	[ ]	Tables and chairs counted back in. Damage logged on this sheet AND in HA Maintenance.	
3	[ ]	Floors swept and mopped. Spills treated, not just wiped.	
4	[ ]	Linens bagged and sent to laundry. Dirty and clean separated.	
5	[ ]	Trash and recycling out to the dumpster. Bins relined for tomorrow.	
6	[ ]	Lost-and-found items bagged, labeled with date and event name, moved to the marked bin.	
7	[ ]	AV equipment powered off, cables coiled and hung on the marked hooks.	
8	[ ]	Microphones returned to the charging case. Confirm all serial numbers on the log.	
9	[ ]	HVAC returned to overnight setting.	
10	[ ]	Event host debrief — any issues written on this sheet for morning shift.	
11	[ ]	Lights off. Doors locked. Alarm armed. Log entry completed at the host stand.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

3. Longneck Kitchen

CLOSING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Kitchen Manager + Front-of-House Lead	Complete within 90 minutes after last cover served.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Last call and final covers served. Check-outs reconciled with every ticket.	
2	[ ]	Dining room reset for tomorrow's breakfast and lunch — tables, silverware, condiments.	
3	[ ]	Kitchen break-down: line cleaned, grills scraped, hood filters wiped.	
4	[ ]	Walk-in and cooler FIFO'd. Dates on every container. Anything without a date goes in the waste log.	
5	[ ]	Waste log completed per zero-waste protocol. No dumpster drops without the log entry.	
6	[ ]	Bar break-down: bottles capped, taps cleaned, glassware washed and put up.	
7	[ ]	Cash drop for every station. Two-staff count for every drawer. Both initial the envelope.	
8	[ ]	All gas valves off at the wall. Fryers filtered. Ovens cooled and wiped.	
9	[ ]	Dish pit closed: machine drained, filters cleaned, dishes put up.	
10	[ ]	Floors swept, mopped, and squeegeed. Mats outside on the rack.	
11	[ ]	Restrooms final check — restocked for tomorrow.	
12	[ ]	HVAC and music set to overnight. Lights to overnight level.	
13	[ ]	Lock all doors. Arm the alarm. Log entry completed at the host stand before leaving.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

4. The Arcade + Redemption Area

CLOSING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Arcade Lead + Redemption Attendant	Complete within 45 minutes after arcade close.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Walk every row. Power down non-24-hour machines per the posted list.	
2	[ ]	Redemption counter: restock low items, inventory every high-value item, log counts on the sheet.	
3	[ ]	Prices re-checked — every item still has a price tag, no missing tags.	
4	[ ]	Cash, card, and token totals reconciled. Two-staff count, both initial.	
5	[ ]	Ticket printers paper level checked for morning. Refill now, not tomorrow.	
6	[ ]	Floors swept. Screens wiped. Trash out to the dumpster.	
7	[ ]	Joysticks, buttons, and high-touch surfaces wiped with approved cleaner.	
8	[ ]	Lost-and-found items moved to the marked bin with date and location.	
9	[ ]	Lock the redemption cage. Keys returned to the key board and signed.	
10	[ ]	Change machines locked. Log final cash level.	
11	[ ]	Lights to overnight level. Doors locked. Alarm armed. Log entry completed.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

5. Pickleball Courts (Outdoor)

CLOSING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Courts Attendant	Complete within 30 minutes after last reserved play.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Paddles and balls returned, counted against the morning count, stored in the bin.	
2	[ ]	Any damaged paddle logged on this sheet AND posted to HA Maintenance.	
3	[ ]	Nets lowered per posted rule — or left up per the weather call, note which.	
4	[ ]	Water station drained. Cups restocked for tomorrow. Ice bin emptied and wiped.	
5	[ ]	Cross-promotion TV powered off.	
6	[ ]	Shade umbrellas closed, anchored, or stored per the weather call.	
7	[ ]	Trash out to the dumpster. Bins relined.	
8	[ ]	Court surfaces swept — leaves, dirt, debris.	
9	[ ]	Sign-up sheet collected and filed at the check-in station.	
10	[ ]	Storage locked. Keys returned to the board and signed.	
11	[ ]	Log entry completed at the check-in station before leaving.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

6. Outside Bar

CLOSING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Bar Lead	Complete within 45 minutes after last call.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Last call at the posted time. Signal bar closed 15 minutes after last call.	
2	[ ]	Bottles capped. Kegs off at the CO2. Taps cleaned.	
3	[ ]	Ice drained. Bins wiped and left to dry overnight.	
4	[ ]	Garnishes covered and refrigerated, or discarded per freshness rule.	
5	[ ]	Cash drop. Two-staff count. Both initial the envelope.	
6	[ ]	Wipe bar top, polish rails, wipe stools, mop behind the bar.	
7	[ ]	Glassware washed, polished, and put up for morning.	
8	[ ]	Menu boards wiped — ready for tomorrow's update.	
9	[ ]	TV powered off. Speakers off.	
10	[ ]	Trash and recycling out to the dumpster. Bins relined.	
11	[ ]	Lock the bar cage. Keys returned to the board and signed.	
12	[ ]	Log entry completed. Alarm armed if bar is a standalone zone.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

7. Sleep-with-Sharks Rooms

CLOSING CHECKLIST

ROLE ASSIGNED	TARGET COMPLETION
Event Host + Housekeeping	Complete within 2 hours after guest morning departure.

#	Done	Task	Initial / Time
1	[ ]	Guest items swept to lost-and-found. Bagged, labeled with date and room.	
2	[ ]	Bedding stripped. Bagged and sent to laundry. Dirty and clean separated.	
3	[ ]	Surfaces sanitized: nightstands, door handles, light switches, bathroom fixtures.	
4	[ ]	Mirror wiped. Tank viewing glass wiped inside the room.	
5	[ ]	Wall content inspected — any missing or damaged pieces logged in HA Leadership WhatsApp.	
6	[ ]	Narration suite QR sign tested again. If broken, posted to HA Maintenance.	
7	[ ]	Trash emptied. Recycling out.	
8	[ ]	Restock for the next booking: water bottles, welcome cards, flashlight batteries checked.	
9	[ ]	Temperature returned to the posted between-bookings setting.	
10	[ ]	Door locked. Placard cleared. Room status updated in the booking system.	
11	[ ]	Log entry completed — room ready or room down, with reason.	

Signed off by: _____ **Time:** _____ **All items complete?** Y / N

NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

Shift Sign-Off Sheet

CLOSING — one line per space. Shift lead signs after each space lead confirms completion.

Space	Lead Initial	Time	Complete? Y/N	Exceptions?
1. Aquarium Exhibit Floor				
2. Studio Giraffe Venue				
3. Longneck Kitchen				
4. The Arcade + Redemption Area				
5. Pickleball Courts (Outdoor)				
6. Outside Bar				
7. Sleep-with-Sharks Rooms				

EXCEPTIONS NOTED BELOW — record anything unfinished, broken, or unusual. Post to HA Maintenance or HA Leadership WhatsApp as required.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

SHIFT LEAD (PRINT) _____ SIGNATURE _____ TIME _____

Cross-Promotion TV Plan

Houston Aquarium

Moving guests from the park into the night economy.

Park closes at 7. Guests leave. Longneck Kitchen, the venue, the arcade, and pickleball sit empty. The park and the night economy are disconnected. TVs are how we reconnect them.

The goal

Every guest sees the full offering before they exit the park. Portrait-oriented TVs at eye level along the guest path convert day-park traffic into dinner covers, venue bookings, arcade play, pickleball reservations, and sleep-with-sharks stays.

Facility

5440 N Sam Houston Pkwy East, Houston. Owner: Ammon Covino.

Scope

Seven screens, one looping playlist, seven 60-second segments, daily runtime 10 AM to 10 PM.

TV hardware specification

Seven portrait-oriented displays placed along the natural guest path. Target size 65–75 inch. Vertical orientation. Center of screen at 60 inches off the floor (average standing eye level).

#	Location	Size	Orientation	Mount (eye center)	Feed
1	Main aquarium exit corridor	75"	Portrait	60 in.	Full playlist
2	Gift shop checkout wall	65"	Portrait	60 in.	Full playlist
3	Redemption counter back wall	65"	Portrait	60 in.	Full playlist
4	Pickleball entry	65"	Portrait	60 in.	Full playlist
5	Outside bar back wall	75"	Portrait	60 in.	Full playlist
6	Longneck Kitchen host station	43"	Portrait	58 in.	Full playlist
7	Sleep-with-sharks intake (lobby)	65"	Portrait	60 in.	Full playlist

Display specification

- Size: 65–75 inch recommended, 4K panel, 500+ nits for well-lit areas.
- Orientation: portrait (vertical). All content mastered 9:16.
- Mount height: center of screen at 60 inches off the floor (eye level).
- Feed: single looping playlist, 60 seconds per segment, 7 minutes total.
- Runtime: 10 AM to 10 PM. Paused automatically during emergency broadcasts.
- Audio: off by default. Captions burned in so content works silent.
- Network: wired ethernet preferred. Each screen has a dedicated media player.

The playlist

Seven segments, roughly 60 seconds each. One loop. Each segment carries the same structure: a visual of the space, a one-sentence voiceover, and a clear call to action.

#	Segment	On-screen	Voiceover	CTA
1	**The Venue — Studio Giraffe**	Room set for a wedding. Kids laughing at a birthday party. The bed from sleep-with-sharks.	Birthday parties, weddings, corporate events, sleep-with-sharks.	Book today at the host station.
2	**Longneck Kitchen**	Plating shot. Dining room full at 7:30. Host greeting a couple.	Dinner service starts at 5. Reservations welcome. Concierge seating.	Waiting menu at the host stand.
3	**The Arcade**	Kid at a game. Redemption counter with a microscope and a rock set.	Redemption prizes worth keeping. Microscopes. Telescopes. Real gear.	Open until 10.
4	**Pickleball**	Two players mid-rally. Paddle rack. Court in evening light.	New courts. Book by the hour. Paddles on site.	Sign up at the pickleball desk.
5	**Sleep-with-Sharks**	Bed against the shark tank. Guest watching sharks. Sunrise through glass.	One night. Real sharks. Real bed.	Ask about availability.
6	**The Gift Shop**	Shelves organized by animal. Adult examining a field guide.	Smithsonian-grade education. Not carnival prizes.	Browse by animal.
7	**Outside Bar**	Band on stage. Full bar at sunset. Plate handed across.	Live music Thursday, Friday, Saturday. Dinner menu available.	Find us in the courtyard.

Creative direction

Visual rules

- Real photography of our spaces and our guests. No stock images. No clip art.
- Shoot on our site during real service hours, with our real staff and guests.
- Natural light where possible. For evening segments, shoot at golden hour.
- Typography on screen: two fonts max, readable from 20 feet. Numbers in tabular nums.
- Music: licensed only. No YouTube rips. One shared music library across all segments.

Shot list per segment (3–4 shots each)

Segment	Shots
Venue	Room set for a dinner party; sleep-with-sharks bed at night; birthday party aftermath with guests smiling.
Longneck Kitchen	Plating shot; host welcoming a couple; bar pour; dining room crowd.
Arcade	Kid playing; redemption counter with Smithsonian goods; prize pickup moment.
Pickleball	Two players mid-rally; paddle rack; evening light on the court.
Sleep-with-Sharks	Bed with shark tank as backdrop; guest looking at sharks before sleep; morning sunrise.
Gift Shop	Animal-section shelves; adult buying an educational item; kid pointing at a microscope.
Outside Bar	Band playing; full bar at sunset; plated food hand-off.

Deployment checklist

Ordered list. Each item is a gate; do not move to the next until the previous is signed off by the GM.

- [ ] Hardware: purchase 7 TVs (65–75 in., portrait-capable) + wall mounts + media players.
- [ ] Electrical: confirm outlets at each location; schedule electrician for any new runs.
- [ ] Content: shoot all 7 segments in a single week of production.
- [ ] Edit: assemble the 7-minute looping playlist. Captions burned in.
- [ ] Test: deploy to ONE location for 3 days. Measure guest mentions at the host stand.
- [ ] Full rollout: all 7 locations live the following week.
- [ ] Monthly refresh: swap in new photography; add seasonal events.

No screen goes live until the playlist is approved by the owner AND the GM. One approval source. No “good enough” shortcuts.

Measurement

How do we know it's working?

Signal	How we measure it
Daily tally — Longneck host stand	Ask every guest: “Did you hear about us from a screen in the park?” Log Y/N.
Daily tally — Pickleball desk	Same question at booking. Log Y/N per booking.
Monthly comp — dinner covers	Compare covers in the 60 days before rollout to the 60 days after.
Monthly comp — venue bookings	Compare birthday/wedding/corporate inquiries before vs. after.
Monthly comp — sleep-with-sharks inquiries	Count inbound inquiries to the intake desk.
Arcade/redemption throughput	Tickets dispensed and redeemed per week, trend over time.

If numbers don't move in 60 days, we change the playlist, not the concept. The TVs stay. The content gets better.

Longneck Kitchen

The restaurant at Houston Aquarium

5440 N Sam Houston Pkwy East, Houston

Approachable American plates with Gulf Coast and Tex-Mex grounding. Made for families, travelers, and date nights. Nothing requires explanation. Everything can be ordered without apology.

Demographic read

Our neighborhood eats at Pappadeaux, Luby's, Pappasito's, and Chili's. We compete with those plate sizes, those price points, and their hospitality standard. Our unique advantage is the aquarium and venue — dinner here is also an experience.

How this document is organized

- Page 2: Menu structure and pricing bands.
- Page 3: The printable menu — two-column layout, ready for the chef.
- Page 4: Bar menu.
- Page 5: Operations notes for the GM.
- Page 6: Opening-week iteration plan.

Menu structure + pricing strategy

Posted to the kitchen wall. Specials stay inside these bands unless the GM approves otherwise.

Category	Price band
Starters / small plates	$8 – $14
Salads	$10 – $15
Kid plates	$7 – $9
Mains (everyday)	$16 – $26
Mains (featured — steaks, seafood)	$28 – $38
Shareables for groups	$22 – $32
Desserts	$7 – $10
Zero-proof drinks	$4 – $7
Beer / wine / cocktails	see bar menu

Rules (posted in kitchen)

- No specials outside posted price bands without GM approval.
- Every plate photographs well — we post food.
- Kids eat free on Sunday 5–7 with a paying adult. Drives family traffic.
- Vegetarian option in every category — labeled (V).
- Gluten-free flagged at the host stand on a dietary card. No custom diet modification on the fly.

STARTERS

Gulf Shrimp Cocktail $12
Six jumbo shrimp, horseradish cocktail sauce, lemon.

Queso Fundido $11
Oaxaca and Monterey jack, chorizo, warm flour tortillas. (V option no chorizo)

Fried Green Tomatoes $9
Remoulade, pickled red onion. (V)

Aquarium Nachos $12
House chips, black beans, queso, pico, jalapeños. Add brisket $4. (V)

Boudin Balls $10
Crispy rice-and-pork boudin, creole mustard.

SALADS

House Salad $10
Mixed greens, tomato, cucumber, buttermilk ranch. (V)

Gulf Caesar $12
Romaine, parmesan, anchovy, cornbread croutons. Add shrimp $6.

Taco Salad $14
Seasoned beef, pepper jack, avocado, lime crema, crisp tortilla bowl.

KID PLATES (12 and under)

Chicken Tenders + Fries $7

Cheese Quesadilla + Rice $7

Mac & Cheese + Broccoli $7

Shrimp Poppers + Fries $9

Every kid plate comes with a juice or milk.

MAINS — EVERYDAY

Longneck Burger $16
Half-pound chuck, cheddar, lettuce, tomato, onion, brioche, fries.

Brisket Plate $22
One-third lb smoked brisket, BBQ beans, slaw, cornbread.

Chicken Fajitas $21
Sizzling skillet, peppers, onions, tortillas, rice, beans.

Beef Enchiladas $19
Three enchiladas, red sauce, queso, rice and beans.

Fried Catfish $18
Two fillets, fries, slaw, hushpuppies, tartar.

Blackened Chicken Pasta $19
Penne, creole cream, bell peppers, parmesan.

Veggie Plate $16
Pick four: mac, greens, beans, corn, sweet potato, cornbread. (V)

MAINS — FEATURED

12 oz NY Strip $34
Grilled, garlic butter, choice of two sides.

Pan-Seared Redfish $32
Crawfish butter sauce, rice, asparagus.

Shrimp & Grits $28
Gulf shrimp, andouille, creamy stone-ground grits.

Aquarium Surf & Turf $38
8 oz sirloin, three shrimp scampi, mashed potatoes.

Blackened Ribeye Tacos $29
Three flour tortillas, avocado, chipotle crema, cotija.

SHAREABLES (serves 2–3)

Fajita Platter for Two $32
Steak + chicken + shrimp, full peppers/onions, tortillas, rice, beans.

Seafood Tower $28
Shrimp cocktail, oysters (6), ceviche, lemon, crackers.

Family Nachos $22
Double portion, three proteins, all the fixings.

SIDES ($5 each)

Fries · Sweet Potato Fries · Mashed Potatoes · Rice · Black or Refried Beans · Greens · Street Corn · Mac & Cheese · Grilled Asparagus · Side Salad

DESSERTS

Tres Leches Cake $8

Pecan Pie + Vanilla Ice Cream $8

Banana Pudding $7

Skillet Chocolate Chip Cookie for Two $10

ZERO-PROOF

Aguas Frescas $5
Horchata, Jamaica, Tamarindo.

Housemade Lemonade $5
Strawberry / mint / classic.

Sweet Tea $4

Unsweet Tea $4

Coffee $4

Sparkling Water $4

Bar menu

Separate section so the kitchen menu doesn't require age ID at the host stand.

BEER

Bucket of Five Domestics — $22
Miller Lite, Bud Light, Michelob Ultra, Modelo, Corona.

Local Draft Rotation — $6 / pint
Rotating local taps. Ask your server.

WINE

House Red / White / Rosé — $9 / $32
By the glass or bottle.

Featured Red — $12 / $42
Changes monthly. Ask your server.

Featured White — $12 / $42
Changes monthly. Ask your server.

COCKTAILS

Longneck Margarita — $10
House tequila, lime, triple sec, salted rim.

Smoked Old Fashioned — $14
Bourbon, demerara, orange, cherrywood smoke.

Watermelon Paloma — $11
Tequila, grapefruit, watermelon, lime.

Aviary Gin & Tonic — $10
Gin, elderflower, cucumber.

Aquarium Blue — $9
Blue curaçao mocktail, coconut, pineapple. Zero-proof option $6.

Bar menu is handed out separately on request. It never crosses the kid plates or family tables by default.

Operations notes for the GM

Area	Standard
Photography in POS	Every dish has a photo inside the POS system — used for training new servers.
Specials board	Updated Monday AM by the GM only. No line-cook freelancing.
Kid-free promotions	Stay inside price band. Sunday 5–7 kids eat free with paying adult.
Dietary flags	A dietary card lives at the host stand. (V) and GF options flagged. No custom diet modifications on the fly.
Waiting menu (pre-seated)	Complimentary chips and salsa + water. That's it. No freebies added during service.
Concierge greeting	Every guest hears the same script at the host stand.

Concierge script

“Welcome to Longneck Kitchen. I'm [name], your host for the evening. Your table is ready. May I start you with something to drink while you look at the menu?”

Opening menu iteration plan

The menu is a hypothesis. We test it, we edit it, we lock it.

Phase	What we do
Weeks 1–4	Run the full menu as printed. Track which items sell and which don't. Daily covers, item-level count, comp ratio.
Week 5	Cut bottom 3 sellers. Replace with 3 test items. Keep the cuts off the specials board — they are dead.
Weeks 6–12	Continue tracking. Allow test items a fair 4-week run before judging.
Month 3	Lock the menu for 6 months. No further changes except seasonal specials that stay inside the posted price bands.

Authority

- Chef and GM have authority to 86 items day-to-day.
- Only the owner + GM approve permanent menu changes.
- Price changes require owner approval.

Discipline beats creativity in the first 90 days. The menu is a system, not a canvas.

Redemption Overhaul

Houston Aquarium — Arcade

Current redemption inventory is carnival-grade. No prices. Low-value plastic items. No connection to our mission as an education center.

Philosophy

Every redemption prize is a teaching object. A microscope is a prize. A rock set is a prize. A magnifying glass at Smithsonian grade is a prize. Plastic dig kits and novelty erasers are not.

The two-shelf rule

If it's educational AND retail-grade, it goes in the gift shop (priced in dollars). If it's educational AND small/token-grade, it goes in redemption (priced in tickets). Nothing plastic and cheap goes in either.

What this document covers

- Page 2: The new redemption inventory — every item, every ticket price.
- Page 3: The split — what belongs in the gift shop instead.
- Page 4: Pricing enforcement and vendor rules.
- Page 5: Deployment checklist.

New redemption inventory (Smithsonian tier)

Exchange rate: approximately 100 tickets per $1 of retail-equivalent value. Three tiers: Small prize (100–500 tickets), Mid prize (500–2,500), Grand prize (2,500–15,000).

Small prizes (100–500 tickets) — teaching tokens

Item	Tier	Retail-equiv.	Ticket price
Polished rock specimen, single piece (labeled)	Small	$1.50	**150**
Animal ID flash-card deck (10 cards)	Small	$2.00	**200**
Pocket ruler with marine-life diagrams	Small	$1.50	**150**
Educational sticker set (species-correct, not cartoon)	Small	$1.00	**100**
Mini notebook with aquarium logo	Small	$2.00	**200**
Pencil set	Small	$1.00	**100**
Compass keychain (functional)	Small	$3.00	**300**
Small seashell (real, responsibly-sourced)	Small	$2.50	**250**

Mid prizes (500–2,500 tickets) — real gear

Item	Tier	Retail-equiv.	Ticket price
Student-grade magnifying glass (glass lens, metal frame)	Mid	$6	**600**
Field notebook with pencil, water-resistant	Mid	$8	**800**
Rock and mineral set (10 labeled specimens, wood box)	Mid	$15	**1,500**
Student-grade compass (metal, functional)	Mid	$10	**1,000**
Bird identification pocket guide	Mid	$7	**700**
Fossil specimen (real, labeled)	Mid	$20	**2,000**
Beginner binoculars (8x21, real optics)	Mid	$25	**2,500**
Pocket knife (kids' version — blunted, 3-tool)	Mid	$18	**1,800**

Grand prizes (2,500–15,000 tickets) — aspirational

Item	Tier	Retail-equiv.	Ticket price
Real binoculars (10x42, field-grade)	Grand	$80	**8,000**
Beginner microscope (40x–400x, metal body)	Grand	$100	**10,000**
Refractor telescope (starter astronomy grade)	Grand	$120	**12,000**
Deluxe rock and mineral set (25 pieces)	Grand	$50	**5,000**
Aquarium annual pass (4-person family)	Grand	$150	**15,000**

The split — what goes to the gift shop instead

Items too valuable or too retail-appropriate for the redemption counter. These live in the gift shop, priced in dollars.

Category	Retail range	Where it goes
Full-size telescopes and microscopes	$80–$300	Gift shop — optics wall
Adult-grade binoculars	$60–$200	Gift shop — optics wall
Premium rock, mineral, and fossil collections	$40–$150	Gift shop — earth sciences
Pocket knives — adult grade	$25–$75	Gift shop — field gear
Field guides, hardcover books, Smithsonian-branded	varies	Gift shop — books
Art prints of aquarium species	varies	Gift shop — by animal section
Plush — species-accurate (not cartoon)	varies	Gift shop — by animal section

Gift shop layout

Organized by animal section, Smithsonian-educational focus (owner's existing rule). Each animal section carries: plush, books, art prints, and a small collection of relevant educational goods. Optics, earth sciences, and field gear get dedicated walls.

Redemption is for tokens that build curiosity. The gift shop is where parents spend real money on serious educational gear. Two different shelves, two different purchase modes.

Pricing enforcement

- EVERY item in redemption has a printed ticket price on the shelf.
- EVERY item in gift shop has a printed dollar price. No “ask cashier” items.
- Price changes approved by GM only. Logged on the pricing sheet with date, item, old price, new price, approver.
- Upper managers approve all purchases. $350 maximum per credit card holder per purchase.

Vendor rules

No carnival supply houses. Period.

Approved vendor categories:

- Education-catalog vendors (Edmund Scientific, similar)
- National Geographic Kids branded goods
- Museum-supply distributors
- Scholastic educational materials
- Smithsonian licensed merchandise

Vendor audit

Cadence	Owner	What we check
Monthly	GM	Purchase log vs. approved vendor list. Any off-list purchase is flagged and must be justified.
Quarterly	Owner + GM	Full vendor list refresh. Add new education-grade vendors; drop anyone who drifted into novelty.
Annually	Owner	Category mix review. Are prizes still connecting to the education mission?

Unpriced merchandise does not leave the counter. If a guest presents an item without a price tag, the staff calls the GM. No exceptions.

Deployment checklist

Sequential. Each step must be signed off by the GM before moving to the next.

- [ ] Inventory current redemption stock. Photograph each item.
- [ ] Sort: KEEP (Smithsonian-grade), MOVE to gift shop, DISCARD (carnival-tier plastic).
- [ ] Order initial stock from the approved vendor list. Budget request to upper managers. $350/card-holder cap applies.
- [ ] Print ticket price tags for every shelf position.
- [ ] Re-merchandise: small prizes at kids' eye-level, mid prizes at adult eye-level, grand prizes in a locked display case with visual access.
- [ ] Train staff: “If it's not priced, it does not leave the counter. Call the GM.”
- [ ] Monthly pricing audit by GM — shelf-by-shelf walk, every price tag checked.
- [ ] Monthly vendor review — no unapproved suppliers in the purchase log.

This overhaul is not a seasonal refresh. It is a category reset. When it's done, a parent walking through the arcade should see gear worth earning — not junk to throw away on the drive home.

Animal Grocery Shopping List — Houston

Whole items only. No substitutions. No measurements by weight.

The Eight Rules

1. **Whole items only.**
   Example: "a papaya, the whole thing." Not "200g of papaya." Never weigh out portions.
2. **No substitutions.**
   If the store is out, ask the GM before buying anything else. Do not swap apples for pears.
3. **No one creates, modifies, or assesses diets.**
   Diets are ALL DONE. This list is the list.
4. **Tortoises eat HAY ONLY.**
   No greens, vegetables, or fruit from this list go to tortoises.
5. **Stingrays, fish, and sharks: zero staff feeding.**
   Never. No live prey is ever authorized.
6. **Birds eat kitchen leftovers first.**
   Only buy dedicated items for birds when leftovers are insufficient — confirmed in writing by the GM.
7. **Feeding instructions and portions come only from steward-to-steward notes.**
   This list is procurement, not feeding.
8. **Upper managers approve all purchases.**
   $350 maximum per credit card holder. Get approval before leaving for the store.

Who this list covers

- Ring-tailed lemurs
- Black-and-white ruffed lemurs
- Any baby lemurs (steward handles prep)
- Cats (treehouse suite area / other mammal areas)
- Other mammals on exhibit (small primates, ringtails)
- Aviary birds — LEFTOVERS first only

Who this list does NOT cover

- Tortoises — HAY ONLY. Nothing from this list.
- Stingrays, fish, sharks — zero staff feeding.

No live prey is ever authorized.

Weekly Shopping List

Remember: whole items, no substitutions, no weight measurements. If a store is out, call the GM before buying anything else.

FRUITS — for lemurs and other mammals					
Item	**Category**	**Weekly quantity (whole items)**	**For which animals**	**Store section**	**Notes**
Papaya	Fruit	4 (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Ripe, not green
Banana	Fruit	2 large bunches (~18-24 bananas)	Lemurs, other mammals	Produce	Ripe with some spots
Mango	Fruit	6 (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Soft but not bruised
Apple (red)	Fruit	10 (whole)	Lemurs, other mammals	Produce	No bruises
Pear	Fruit	6 (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Firm, not mushy
Grapes (green or red)	Fruit	2 lb bags	Lemurs	Produce	Whole clusters
Cantaloupe	Fruit	2 (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Ripe
Watermelon (small)	Fruit	1 (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Seasonal
Orange	Fruit	8 (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Navel preferred
Strawberry	Fruit	2 containers (1 lb each)	Lemurs	Produce	Whole, not pre-cut
Blueberry	Fruit	2 pints	Lemurs, other mammals	Produce	Fresh
Pineapple	Fruit	1 (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Ripe

LEAFY GREENS — for lemurs and other mammals (NOT tortoises)					
Item	**Category**	**Weekly quantity (whole items)**	**For which animals**	**Store section**	**Notes**
Romaine lettuce	Greens	4 heads	Lemurs, other mammals	Produce	Whole heads, no bagged salad
Kale	Greens	3 bunches	Lemurs	Produce	Curly or dino, whole bunches
Collard greens	Greens	2 bunches	Lemurs	Produce	Whole bunches, not chopped

Item	Category	Weekly quantity (whole items)	For which animals	Store section	Notes
Spinach	Greens	2 containers (5 oz each)	Lemurs	Produce	Fresh, not frozen
Swiss chard	Greens	2 bunches	Lemurs	Produce	Whole
Dandelion greens	Greens	2 bunches	Lemurs	Produce (if available)	Seasonal — if not available, ask GM before buying alternate
Parsley (flat-leaf)	Greens	2 bunches	Lemurs	Produce	Fresh, not dried

VEGETABLES — for lemurs and other mammals

Item	Category	Weekly quantity (whole items)	For which animals	Store section	Notes
Sweet potato	Vegetable	6 (whole)	Lemurs, other mammals	Produce	Firm, no soft spots
Carrot	Vegetable	4 lb bag	Lemurs, other mammals	Produce	Whole carrots with tops OK
Celery	Vegetable	2 bunches	Lemurs	Produce	Whole stalks
Cucumber	Vegetable	6 (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Firm
Bell pepper (red, yellow, green)	Vegetable	6 total (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Any color
Zucchini	Vegetable	6 (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Firm
Broccoli	Vegetable	3 heads (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	Fresh
Cauliflower	Vegetable	2 heads (whole)	Lemurs	Produce	White, firm
Green bean (fresh)	Vegetable	2 lb	Lemurs	Produce	Whole, not canned

Cat / other mammal notes

Cat-safe fruits from the list above (banana, blueberry, apple) may be used only when a steward-to-steward note requests it in writing.

Cat diets are primarily steward-handled with prescribed cat food. Grocery supplement is occasional and only on steward-to-steward instruction. Do not supplement without a written note.

Bird section — leftovers first

Confirm with the kitchen: leftover fruit scraps, bread ends, cooked rice, and vegetable trimmings are collected daily into the aviary bin. Birds eat leftovers — there is no reason to throw food away.

Dedicated bird purchases only on GM approval when leftovers are insufficient. If approved, buy: millet spray, whole corn cobs, apple, whole grapes.

Whole items. No substitutions. No weight-based portions. Ever.

The NOT-on-this-list list

Do not buy these items. Do not put these in any animal enclosure.

- ✗ **Anything pre-cut, pre-washed, or bagged salad mixes**
  Contamination risk plus preservatives. Whole items only.
- ✗ **Frozen fruits or vegetables**
  Fresh only. No exceptions.
- ✗ **Canned fruits or vegetables**
  No. Fresh only.
- ✗ **Dried fruit**
  Sugar is too concentrated.
- ✗ **Avocado**
  Toxic to many species. Never.
- ✗ **Onion, garlic, shallot, leek**
  Toxic. Never.
- ✗ **Grapes for cats**
  Ask the steward first. Grapes go to lemurs only unless a steward note says otherwise.
- ✗ **Chocolate, candy, processed food of any kind**
  Never.
- ✗ **Nuts**
  Only on a specific steward-to-steward note. Not on the standing list.
- ✗ **Dairy products**
  No milk, cheese, yogurt, butter.
- ✗ **Bread, crackers, cereal**
  The leftovers protocol covers bread — for birds only, from the kitchen, not from the store.
- ✗ **Any meat, fish, or animal protein**
  Live prey is never authorized. All protein feeding is steward-managed.
- ✗ **Anything sold as "for pets" or "for zoo animals"**
  We do not substitute grocery items with pet-food products.

Reminder

If you are not sure, do not buy it. Call the GM. No substitutions. Whole items only. This list is the list.

Shopping trip checklist

Work top to bottom. Do not skip steps.

- [ ] Confirm list with GM before leaving.
- [ ] Confirm budget with upper manager. Maximum $350 per credit card holder.
- [ ] Bring a cooler for the drive back if the trip will exceed 30 minutes.
- [ ] Receipt MUST be submitted to GM within 24 hours of the trip.
- [ ] Any substitution that is NOT on the approved list = return the item to the store.
- [ ] Log delivery time on the HA Husbandry group when items arrive at the facility.
- [ ] Store fruits and greens per the standard cooler protocol (posted separately).
- [ ] Do NOT portion, chop, or prep food — that is the steward's job and follows steward-to-steward notes.

Non-negotiables

- Whole items only. Never weigh out animal portions.
- No substitutions without written GM approval.
- Tortoises eat hay only — not one item from this list.
- Stingrays, fish, sharks: zero staff feeding.
- Birds eat leftovers first.
- Diets are ALL DONE. No one creates, modifies, or assesses diets.

Weekly planning template

Fill in before leaving. Submit with receipt to GM.

Week of:	_____
Shopper:	_____
Approved by (GM):	_____
Upper manager signature:	_____
Budget approved:	$ _____
Store:	_____
Trip date:	_____
Trip time:	_____
Receipt total:	$ _____

Items missing / substitutions requested

Every line below requires written GM approval before any alternate is purchased.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Delivery confirmation

Confirmed in HA Husbandry group: Y / N **Time:** _____

Shopper signature: _____ **GM signature:** _____

Whole items. No substitutions. This list is the list.